

Ideation Phase

Brainstorming, Idea Generation & Solution Prioritization

Attribute	Project Information
Project Title	Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer
Phase / Stage	1. Ideation Phase
Document Title	Brainstorming & Idea Prioritization
Platform & Scope	ServiceNow Utah / Vancouver / Washington DC (Global Scope)
Team ID	SWTID-2026-4988

1. Ideation Workshop Overview

A collaborative brainstorming session was conducted to explore architectural mechanisms for automating incident classification in ServiceNow. The team reviewed legacy helpdesk challenges, analyzed historical ticket records from academic institutions, and generated multiple candidate approaches across technical and operational domains.

2. Candidate Approaches Evaluated

Approach ID	Proposed Solution Concept	Technical Architecture	Pros	Cons & Bottlenecks	Viability Decision
Option A	Manual Triage Shift Rotation	Organizational policy assigning dedicated junior technicians on rotating shifts solely to triage incoming tickets.	No ServiceNow configuration changes needed.	High labor cost, does not scale during surges, human error remains high, zero improvement during off-hours.	REJECTED
Option B	Scripted Business Rules & Client Scripts	Server-side JavaScript Business Rules (onBefore / onAfter insert) running regex pattern matching on incident fields.	High flexibility and complex logic capabilities.	Requires scripting expertise, increases maintenance technical debt, difficult for non-coder admins to adjust keywords.	REJECTED (Alternative)

Approach ID	Proposed Solution Concept	Technical Architecture	Pros	Cons & Bottlenecks	Viability Decision
Option C	Predictive Intelligence (Machine Learning)	ServiceNow Predictive Intelligence plugin utilizing supervised NLP machine learning classification algorithms.	Learns from historical data and adapts over time.	Requires expensive enterprise licensing, requires tens of thousands of clean historical records, black-box classification behavior.	DEFERRED (Future Scope)
Option D	Flow Designer No-Code Automation (SELECTED)	Native ServiceNow Workflow Studio / Flow Designer trigger on Record Created, executing keyword conditional branching and record updates.	100% no-code, easily maintainable, visual execution tracking, instant trigger, integrates native email actions.	Requires upfront definition of standard keyword taxonomy.	ACCEPTED AS PRIMARY SOLUTION

3. Solution Prioritization Matrix (Value vs. Complexity)

Initiative / Component	Business Value (1-5)	Feasibility (1-5)	Implementation Effort	Calculated Score	Priority Rank
Custom Table Schema (u_incident_workflow) & Auto Numbering	5	5	Low (1 Day)	25	Rank 1 (Immediate)
Dependent Choice List Configuration (Category -> Subcategory)	5	5	Low (1 Day)	25	Rank 2 (Immediate)
Flow Designer Keyword-Based Auto-Classification Flow	5	5	Low-Medium (2 Days)	25	Rank 3 (Immediate)
Automated Outbound Caller Confirmation Email Notification	5	5	Low (1 Day)	25	Rank 4 (Immediate)
Local Update Set Packaging & XML Export Configuration	4	5	Low (0.5 Day)	20	Rank 5 (Immediate)

Initiative / Component	Business Value (1-5)	Feasibility (1-5)	Implementation Effort	Calculated Score	Priority Rank
Predictive Intelligence ML Classification Model	3	2	High (3-4 Weeks)	6	Rank 6 (Future Roadmap)

4. Implementation Roadmap & Conclusion

The Flow Designer automation solution emerged as the undisputed winner across all evaluation dimensions. It guarantees maximum business impact with zero-code simplicity, complete transparency, and native ServiceNow integration. The next phase will formulate the formal system requirements, technical stack specifications, and user stories.